

Maya Bell

ACT I / Before the murder

Your history with Sterling

Sterling's gift conditions would cut public education programming to fund a private donor lounge and VIP entrance.

What you are hiding

You organized an anonymous staff petition against the plan and slipped copies into trustee folders. Do not volunteer this immediately. In Act II, protect it unless interrogation forces your hand; in Act III, reveal it if you need to defend yourself.

Your objectives

- Protect your private complication until you decide disclosure helps you.
- Use your public relationships to trade information rather than waiting for clues to come to you.
- Ask at least two people where they were during the poisoning window.

What you know about other guests

- One draft of Sterling's gift would move money away from education and community programming.
- Adrian is under extraordinary pressure over Sterling's naming and governance demands.

Notes / Who will you speak to first?

ACT II / After Sterling dies

Follow your assigned branch. Keep it private. If you are the murderer, the innocent branch is a cover story you may claim.

IF INNOCENT

Adrian and Riley both place you in the Grand Gallery during the key minutes.

IF MURDERER

You entered at 6:47 to leave the petition, poisoned the cordial, and left a docent pin by the tray.

ACT III / Evidence update

Your sealed evidence pair contains Cards A and B. If you are INNOCENT, secretly submit Card B. If you are the MURDERER, secretly submit Card A. Put the unused card away.

FINAL STATEMENT / Read only if called

IF INNOCENT

I organized the anonymous staff petition against Sterling's plan to cut education programs for a private donor lounge. I was willing to embarrass him with signatures. Adrian saw me in the Grand Gallery while the poison was added. Museums are for people; murder is not public programming.

IF MURDERER

Sterling was going to build a private entrance by cutting the programs that let the public feel the museum belonged to them. I went in with the petition, poisoned his cordial, and lost my docent pin behind the table. I told myself I was protecting access. I destroyed something far more basic.

Investigation notes
